

Yogesh KULKARNI

 [yogkul2000.github.io](https://github.com/yogkul2000)  ykulka10@asu.edu  [Google Scholar](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research develops post-training methods for video-language models that reason over long-horizon spatial, temporal, and audio-visual content. I study preference alignment and reinforcement learning with structured signals for data-efficient multimodal reasoning, including adaptive reasoning and proactive decision-making in continuous egocentric streams.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University, TEMPE, AZ, USA

Ph.D. in Computer Science Advisor : [Dr. Pooyan Fazli](#)

University of Southern California, LOS ANGELES, CA, USA

Master of Science in Computer Science

Pune Institute of Computer Technology, PUNE, India

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “AVATAR : Reinforcement Learning to See, Hear, and Reason Over Video.” *IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR 2026)*. [PDF]
- [2] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “EgoVITA : Learning to Plan and Verify for Egocentric Video Reasoning.” *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV 2026)*. [PDF]
- [3] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “Video-FLAIR : Not Whether to Reason, But How.” *arXiv preprint, 2026*. [PDF]
- [4] Chaoyu Li, **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “ReGATE : Learning Faster and Better with Fewer Tokens in MLLMs.” *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Main 2026)*. [PDF]
- [5] Chaoyu Li, Xiaoyi Gu, **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Eun Woo Im, Mohammadmahdi Honarmand, et al. “Video Generation Models : A Survey of Post-Training and Alignment.” *Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR 2026)*. [Paper]
- [6] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “VideoPASTA : 7K Preference Pairs That Matter for Video-LLM Alignment.” *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP Main 2025)*. [PDF]
- [7] **Yogesh Kulkarni**, Pooyan Fazli. “VideoSAVi : Self-Aligned Video Language Models without Human Supervision.” *Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2025)*. [PDF]

EXPERIENCE

Present May 2026	Adobe Research, SAN JOSE, CA, USA <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> Mentor : Dr. Puneet Mathur ➢ Developed proactive reasoning omni models that decide when and what to say during lecture videos trained with GRPO and on-policy self-distillation on a reason-then-speak objective.
Present Aug 2024	People and Robots Laboratory (PeRL), ARIZONA STATE UNIVERSITY, Tempe, AZ <i>Graduate Researcher</i> Advisor : Dr. Pooyan Fazli ➢ Video reasoning models (CVPR’26), egocentric and procedural video understanding (ECCV’26), video-language alignment (EMNLP’25, COLM’25), and efficient training for multimodal LLMs (ACL’26).
Aug 2023 May 2023	Nokia Bell Labs, NEW PROVIDENCE, NJ, USA <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> Mentor : Dr. Thomas Woo ➢ Implemented automatic model parallelism for GPT-3 and LLaMA, increasing training throughput by 15% across heterogeneous clusters. Designed communication- and compute-efficient inter-node pipeline parallelism for geo-distributed GPUs.
Mar 2024 Jan 2023	USC Institute for Creative Technologies, LOS ANGELES, CA, USA <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> Advisor : Dr. Meida Chen ➢ Built a 3D style transfer pipeline with ViT, CLIP, and Gaussian Splatting for text-guided point-cloud coloring. Explored DDPMs and GANs with PointNet, KPConv, and SparseUNet for 3D colorization.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer : NeurIPS, CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, ACL Rolling Review (ARR), TPAMI, and TMLR.